

Language Lab Worksheet: False Friends: The Backstabbers of Language

Vocabulary List:

 **1. *Cross with somebody*** - If someone's *cross* with you, it means they're annoyed — like mildly angry but still pretending to be polite.

 **2. *Somewhere along the line*** - This means “at some point during a process or timeline”. Unclear when, but it happened.

 **3. *Go awry [erai]*** - When your big plan turns into a big mess.

 **4. *Stab in the back*** - Figurative betrayal. Usually by someone you trust.

 **5. *Vernacular*** - A fancy word for everyday speech.

 **6. *Retirement*** - when you stop working and start golfing, gardening, or getting super into sudoku.

 **7. *Et al.*** - Latin for "and others," commonly used in academic writing to avoid listing five million authors.

 **8. *Umbrella term*** - A single word that covers a whole category. “Fruit” is an umbrella term for apples, oranges, and whatever durian is trying to be.

 **9. *Start from scratch*** - Begin with nothing — no materials, no prior progress. Like baking a cake without a mix.

 **10. *Utensils*** - an umbrella term for Forks, knives, spoons — and that one weird spork you keep for camping.

 **12. *Blind date*** - A date with someone you've never met.

 **13. *Vent / Rant about something*** - To let out frustration (vent) or go on a dramatic speech about it (rant). Usually involves a raised voice and a lot of hand gestures.

 **14. *Don't take my word for it*** - Basically: “Fact-check me if you want. I could be wrong, but I'm probably right. Don't quote me on that - which means the same.”

 **15. Gem (literal and figurative)** - Literal: shiny, precious, usually expensive stone like: ruby, emerald, sapphire, et al. Figurative: something or someone that's lovely, delightful, or rare.

 **16. Keep up** - To stay at the same pace as others — mentally, physically, or emotionally.

 **17. H-E Double Hockey Sticks** - A cute way of saying "hell" without alarming small children or your grandma.

 **18. Don't butcher me** - Don't harshly criticize me for what I'm about to say.

 **19. Hilarious** - More than just funny — *hilarious* is laugh-out-loud, snort-noise-inducing humor. Peak funny.

 **20. Meme (pronunciation alert!)** - It's pronounced "meem." One syllable. Rhymes with "scream."

 **21. Scratch the surface** - To barely begin understanding or exploring something.

Part 1: Match the Word to the Definition

Term	Meaning
___ Cross with somebody	A) Begin with absolutely nothing but hope and caffeine
___ Vernacular	B) When your plan falls apart like a poorly made cake
___ Go awry	C) Feeling betrayed by your friend's "surprise promotion"
___ Stab in the back	D) Mildly angry — polite people's way of saying furious
___ Umbrella term	E) Word that covers a bunch of stuff
___ Start from scratch	F) Common language used by regular people, not wizards

Part 2: Fill in the Blank

- I didn't know who I was meeting — it was a total _____ date.
- My weekend plan to relax went horribly _____ when my dog ate my charger.
- "Don't _____ me, but I think I actually liked pineapple on pizza."
- Somewhere along the _____, I became obsessed with ceramic frogs.
- That meme was _____ — I couldn't stop laughing.

Part 3: Multiple Choice



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1. *What does “keep up” mean?*
 - a) To store something
 - b) To maintain pace
 - c) To decorate quickly
 - d) To interrupt rudely
 2. *What’s the correct pronunciation of “meme”?*
 - a) Meh-meh
 - b) Mee-mee
 - c) Meem
 - d) May-may
 3. *What’s an example of an “umbrella term”?*
 - a) Spoon
 - b) Emotion
 - c) Umbrella
 - d) Tiny hat
 4. *What’s a blind date?*
 - a) A dinner in the dark
 - b) A date with someone you’ve never met
 - c) A romantic walk with eyes closed
 - d) None of the above
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Part 4: Reflection Prompts

1. Have you ever *ranted* about something that later seemed a bit dramatic? What happened?
2. Think of a time when something *went awry*. What did you learn?
3. What’s one *gem* of advice you’ve received — literal or figurative?
4. Can you use “scratch the surface” in a sentence about something you’re curious to learn more about?

